worlds, of their possible war, of their coexistence, etc., all too often forgetting that there exists a third one, the most important, and in fact the first one in chronological terms. This is the body of those that we call, in United Nations fashion, the underdeveloped countries. (…) The underdeveloped countries, the 3rd world, have entered into a new phase (…). Because at last this ignores, exploited Third World, looked down on as the Third State, also wants to be something else".

The term soon figured in the Bandung Conference of 1955, the first forum of the Third World countries which laid the foundation of the non-aligned movement. During the heydays of Cold War, the term designated the countries neither aligned with the western powers (the first world), nor the communist bloc (the second world). From this perspective, the Third World more or less represented a kind of 'Third Force'.

As Calvocoressi[5] pointed out, "It was a Third World because it rejected the notion of a world divided into two worlds in which only the United States and the USSR counted and everybody else had to declare for the one or the other. It feared the power of the superpowers, exemplified and magnified by nuclear weapons. It distrusted their intentions, envied their superior wealth and rejected their insistence that, in one case in democratic capitalism and in the other in communism, they had discovered a way of life which others need do no more than copy". Therefore, these countries were neither in favour of Moscow's rigid communism nor Washington's hatred for communism and believed in non-alignment with any of the power blocs.

The Chinese concept forwarded by Mao looked at the Third World from a different perspective. For Mao, "The United States and the Soviet Union form the First World. Japan, Europe and Canada the middle section, which belong to the Second World. We are the Third World. The Third World has a huge population. With the exception of Japan, Asia belongs to the Third World. The Whole of Africa belongs to the Third World and Latin America". It is believed by the scholars that the Chinese stratification was based on power and there was a hidden objective of propounding this theory of Third World. China